NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 1 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • C1250–C1500

Medicine in Medieval Britain, c1250–c1500

c1250–c1500: Ideas on Causes, Prevention, Treatment, Medical Care & The Black Death



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • C.1350 MS 13076 • FOLIO 24V

Omne Bonum: Clerics Ministering to Plague Victims with Buboes

James le Palmer (fl. 1360–1375) • Fourteenth-century illuminated manuscript showing two plague sufferers bearing bubonic sores in bed while priests administer last rites and prayer.

PRIMARY VISUAL EVIDENCE THE BRITISH LIBRARY MANUSCRIPT COLLECTION

PEARSON EDEXCEL OPTION 11 • KEY TOPIC 1 CONTENT OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

1 Ideas About the Cause of Disease and Illness

- **Supernatural and religious explanations** of the cause of disease.
- Rational explanations: the **Theory of the Four Humours** and the **miasma theory**; the continuing influence in England of **Galen**.

2 Approaches to Prevention and Treatment

- Approaches to prevention and treatment, and their connection with ideas about disease and illness: religious actions, **bloodletting and purging**, **purifying the air**.
- Medical training and traditional approaches to treatment and care for the sick: the role of the **physician, apothecary and barber surgeon**; the role of hospitals, care within the community and at home,

3 Case Study

- Dealing with the **Black Death, 1348–49**; approaches to treatment and attempts to prevent its spread.

🎯 **CASE STUDY DEPTH FOCUS**

National & Local Dimensions: Contrasting supernatural beliefs (divine wrath, flagellants) and humoral purging against King Edward III's 1349 cleanliness order and London quarantine pits.

EXAM MATRIX EDEXCEL PAPER 1 SECTION B EXAMINATION TARGETING FRAMEWORK • THEMATIC STUDY [36M + 4M SPAG • 55 MINS] SPECIFICATION 1HI0/11

Q3 • 4 MARKS AO1/AO2 CONCEPT DRILL

Similarity or Difference Across Eras

Target: Explain 1 way [ideas / treatments / care] in this era were similar or different to another period.
Rule: Provide specific factual evidence from *both* named periods to secure 4/4 marks (approx. 5 mins).

Practice: In-Workbook 4-Mark Comparative Tasks

Q4 • 12 MARKS AO1/AO2 CAUSATION

Explain Why [Causal Change] Occurred

Target: Multi-causal analytical essay explaining why medical change or continuity took place.
Rule: Write 3 developed PEEL paragraphs. Must address both stimulus points + 1 distinct point of own knowledge (18 mins).

Practice: Chronological Inquiry Spine & Causation Drills

Q5/6 • 16+4 SPaG AO1/AO2/AO4 SYNOPTIC

'How Far Do You Agree?' Evaluative Essay

Target: Choose Q5 OR Q6. Evaluative thematic essay assessing factor significance or change over time.
Rule: Balanced argument (for/against) with sustained criteria and a decisive historical verdict (30 mins).

Practice: Full 16-Mark Extended Writing Frames

Supernatural Dogma, Humoral Theory & Medieval Medical Care

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Continuity & Church Control to the left • Treatments & Care to the right).

◂ SIN, ASTROLOGY & CENSORSHIP

c.1250 Church Control & Galenic Dogma (KT 1.1)

PILGRIMAGE, PRAYER & GALEN ▸

◂ IMBALANCE & BAD AIR (MIASMA)

c.1280 Four Humours & Theory of Opposites (KT 1.2)

OPPOSITES & UROSCOPY CHARTS ▸

◂ ZODIAC MAN & BLOODLETTING

c.1300 Phlebotomy, Purging & Regimens (KT 1.3)

HERBAL THERIAC & REGIMEN RULES ▸

◂ ELITE UNIVERSITY PHYSICIANS

c.1320 Physicians, Apothecaries & Barbers (KT 1.4)

BARBERS, APOTHECARIES & WOMEN ▸

SPECIFICATION SPINE CONTINUES TO HOSPITALS & THE BLACK DEATH (PAGE 3) ➔

‘Care Not Cure’ Hospitals & The Black Death Crisis (1348–1349)

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Perceived Causes & Limits to the left • Responses & Action to the right).

◂ INFECTIOUS PATIENTS EXCLUDED

c.1340 Monastic Hospitals: ‘Care Not Cure’ (KT 1.4)

HOSPITALITY, WARMTH & PRAYER ▸

◂ MARS, JUPITER & SATURN ALIGN

1345 Planetary Alignment & Miasma Fears (KT 1.1 • 1.5)

CORRUPTED AIR & DIVINE WRATH ▸

◂ BUBONIC & PNEUMONIC PLAGUE

1348 The Black Death Hits England (KT 1.5)

FLAGELLANTS, LANCING & HERBS ▸

◂ OVERFLOWING BURIAL TRENCHES

1349 Edward III’s Cleanliness & Quarantine (KT 1.5)

STREET CLEANING & QUARANTINE ▸

KEY TOPIC 1 SPECIFICATION SPINE COMPLETE ➔

Why did the Catholic Church dominate medieval explanations of disease?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 c1250 • Why was disease believed to be a direct punishment sent by God?

- Divine punishment for sin
- Original sin & human fallen state
- Prayer & repentance as primary cure

2 c1280 • Why was leprosy viewed as visible proof of divine judgment?

- Biblical leprosy moral stigma
- Exile to isolated Lazar houses
- Warning wooden clappers & bells

3 1345 • How did the Church reconcile astrology with Christian doctrine?

- Zodiac Man parchment wheels
- 1345 planetary conjunction
- Mars, Saturn & Jupiter alignment

4 c1350 • Why did sick people turn to pilgrimage shrines rather than doctors?

- Arduous pilgrimage to Canterbury
- Kissing holy relics of saints
- Chantry masses & sale of indulgences

5 c1400 • Why did church enforcement of Galen prevent medical progress?

- Monastic scriptoria Latin copying
- Galen purposeful creator dogma
- Roger Bacon imprisoned for heresy (1277)

If you develop a fever in 1300, church logic dictates you definitely committed a sin last Tuesday. Time to buy a pilgrimage badge!

Question 5: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT

'In the medieval period (c1250–c1500), ideas about the cause of illness were mainly based on religion.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

Stimulus: the Church | miasma *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *To a large extent, it can be argued that... • On the one hand, a major religious belief was that... • Furthermore, this meant that... • On the other hand, an alternative rational explanation was... • In conclusion, the decisive reason why...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on facing page)

MIND-MAP MISSION Open the Consolidate Station in the app and branch out KT1.1 on Pages 2–3: map Church manuscript control and Roger Bacon's arrest (left) against pilgrimage and prayer (right). [ ] Done

Continue your response to Question 5 below:

• **QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE SIMILARITY [4 MARKS]** SCORE: [/ 4] • 5 MINS

Explain one way in which ideas about the cause of disease in the Medieval period (c1250–c1500) were similar to ideas in the Renaissance period (c1500–c1700). [4 marks]

Identify 1 valid similarity, then explain with specific historical detail from both named eras.

Why did the Theory of the Four Humours dominate rational medicine for centuries?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 c460 BC • How did Hippocrates separate medicine from superstition?

- Hippocratic clinical method
- Rejection of gods
- Hippocratic Oath ethics

2 c1250 • Why did humoral theory seem logical to medieval people?

- Four bodily humours
- Blood, phlegm & biles
- Seasonal balance system

3 c1280 • How did the Theory of Opposites provide practical treatment rules?

- Galen Theory of Opposites
- Contraries cure contraries
- Animal dissection errors

4 c1300 • Why did uroscopy give physicians great diagnostic authority?

- Uroscopy urine flask (matula)
- Urine diagnostic wheel
- Zodiac Man alignment

5 c1350 • Why did rational physicians link bad smells directly to epidemics?

- Miasma theory (bad air)
- Cesspool stench fears
- Unbalanced bodily fluids

Question 4: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT

Explain why there was little change in medicine in England during the medieval period (c1250–c1500). [12 marks]

Stimulus: Galen | monastery hospitals *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

MIND-MAP MISSION Open the Consolidate Station in the app and branch out KT1.2 on Pages 2–3: map humoral imbalance and miasma (left) against Galen's Theory of Opposites and uroscopy charts (right). [ ] Done

Sniffing urine, tasting urine, holding urine up to the window. 14th-century diagnostics was 90% liquid inspection and 10% guessing.

Continue your response to Question 4 below:

• QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE DIFFERENCE [4 MARKS] SCORE: [/ 4] • 5 MINS

Explain one way in which ideas about the cause of disease in the Medieval period (c1250–c1500) were different from ideas in the Modern period (c1900–present). [4 marks]

Identify 1 valid difference, then explain with specific historical detail from both named eras.

How did medieval people attempt to treat and prevent disease, and why did rational and religious methods coexist?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 c1250 • Why did ordinary people consider prayer more vital than medicine?

- Penance & fasting
- Chanted Latin prayers
- Flagellant whipping processions

2 c1300 • Why was bloodletting the most universal physical treatment?

- Phlebotomy vein incision
- Iron fleams & leeches
- Cupping & pewter bowls

3 c1320 • How was purging believed to restore bodily equilibrium?

- Emetics (black hellebore)
- Laxatives & clysters
- Humoural fluid evacuation

4 c1350 • Why did herbal recipes remain popular across all social classes?

- Herbal Materia Medica
- Theriac (70 ingredients)
- Local apothecaries remedies

5 c1400 • How did wealthy barons attempt to prevent sickness before it struck?

- Regimen Sanitatis rules
- Sweet pomander scents
- Lavender & burning tar

Bleeding, purging, boiling vinegar, and swallowing crushed emeralds. If the disease didn't kill you, the apothecary's bill definitely would.

Question 5: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

'The main reason why medical care and treatment was ineffective during the medieval period, c1250–c1500, was because medical knowledge was based on Galen's ideas.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

Stimulus: Theory of Opposites | hospitals *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *To a large extent, it can be argued that... • On the one hand, a major reason treatment was ineffective was... • For example, ... • On the other hand, another decisive factor was... • In conclusion, the main reason why...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

MIND-MAP MISSION Open the Consolidate Station in the app and branch out KT1.3 on Pages 2–3: map Zodiac Man bloodletting and purging (left) against herbal theriac and Regimen Sanitatis rules (right). [ ] Done

Continue your response to Question 5 below:

• **QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE SIMILARITY [4 MARKS]** **SCORE: [/ 4] • 5 MINS**

Explain one way in which ideas about the prevention of illness in the medieval period (c1250–c1500) were similar to ideas about the prevention of illness in the Renaissance period (c1500–c1700). [4 marks]

Identify 1 valid similarity, then explain with specific historical detail from both named eras.

Who provided medical care in medieval England, and why did hospitals focus on care rather than cure?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 c1250 • Why were university physicians accessible only to the ultra-wealthy?

- University-trained physicians
- Latin texts & star charts
- High diagnostic fees

2 c1300 • How did apothecaries provide accessible medicines to townspeople?

- Apothecary guild trade
- Herbal preparations sold
- Cheaper urban access

3 c1320 • Why were barber-surgeons viewed as lower-status craftsmen?

- Barber-surgeon guild
- Bloodletting & tooth pulling
- Cauterisation & amputation

4 c1350 • Why did monastic hospitals deliberately avoid medical treatment?

- Monastic charity hospitals
- Care not cure philosophy
- Bed rest & prayer

5 c1400 • Why did the vast majority of sick people rely on female family members?

- Domestic women healers
- Local herb gardening
- Midwifery & home care

Question 4: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING ASSESSMENT

Explain why hospital care in medieval England was based on the concept of 'care rather than cure' in the period c1250–c1500. [12 marks]

Stimulus: **the role of the Church** **lack of medical knowledge** *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

MIND-MAP MISSION Open the Consolidate Station in the app and branch out KT1.4 on Pages 2–3: map university physicians vs wise women and explain why monastic hospitals practiced 'care not cure'. **[ ] Done**

Barber-surgeons: short back and sides, pull out a molar, lance a boil, amputate a leg. Multi-tasking at its finest and bloodiest.

Continue your response to Question 4 below:

• **QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE DIFFERENCE [4 MARKS]** **SCORE: [/ 4] • 5 MINS**

Explain one way in which the work of hospitals in the Medieval period (c1250–c1500) was different from hospitals in the nineteenth century. [4 marks]

Identify 1 valid difference, then explain with specific historical detail from both named eras.

Why did medieval society fail to halt the devastating mortality of the Black Death?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 June 1348 • How did trade routes unwittingly bring the plague to England?

- Melcombe Regis port (1348)
- Yersinia pestis bacteria
- Black rats & fleas

2 Autumn 1348 • Why was the pneumonic strain far deadlier than the bubonic form?

- Bubonic groin swellings (buboes)
- Pneumonic bloody coughing
- Mortality in three days

3 Winter 1348 • Why were medical treatments completely useless against the plague?

- Divine wrath & miasma
- Lancing buboes & live hens
- Bleeding & crushed emeralds

4 1349 • How did belief in miasma shape royal prevention orders?

- Quarantine isolation rules
- Cleaning town butchery waste
- Street fire smoke barriers

5 1349–1350 • Why did the Black Death trigger a long-term social and economic crisis?

- Mass burial trenches
- Third to half population lost
- Labour shortage & wage rises

In 1348, people blamed God, the planets, bad smells, and foreigners. The actual culprits—fleas on black rats—went completely unnoticed.

Question 5: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

'There was little progress in understanding the cause of disease in the years c1250–c1700.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

Stimulus: **the Great Plague in London, 1665** **Thomas Sydenham** *(You must also use information of your own)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *To a large extent, it can be argued that... • On the one hand, there was profound continuity because... • For example, during the Great Plague of 1665... • On the other hand, there were emerging challenges to tradition... • In conclusion, the degree of progress was...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

MIND-MAP MISSION Open the Consolidate Station in the app and branch out KT1.5 on Pages 2–3: map 1348 plague causes and symptoms (left) against flagellants, quarantine, and Edward III's street-cleaning order (right). **[ ] Done**

Continue your response to Question 5 below:

• **QUESTION 3: EXPLAIN ONE SIMILARITY [4 MARKS]** **SCORE: [/ 4] • 5 MINS**

Explain one way in which responses to the Black Death (1348–49) were similar to responses to the Great Plague of London (1665). [4 marks]

Identify 1 valid similarity, then explain with specific historical detail from both named eras.

KEY TOPIC 1 NOTES & EXAMINATION STRATEGY

Notes: Record key causal links, essay plans, and teacher feedback for this unit.

PUPIL NAME: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐

HW DATES & QR	ENQUIRY FOCUS & PARENTAL HOMEWORK VERIFICATION 1. Scan QR to read aloud / track audio narration • 2. Complete 10-Q online quiz • 3. Parent verifies & signs	DO NOW (10M) Topic Recall	Q3 SIM/DIFF	Q4/5 EXTENDED
SET: _____  DUE: _____	**KT1.1: Supernatural & Religious Explanations of Disease** *"Why did the Catholic Church dominate medieval explanations of disease?"* ☐ **Read Aloud / Audio Tracked** **10-Q Online Quiz Score:** _____ **/ 10** **Parent / Carer Signature:** _____	**KT 1.1 RECALL** _____ **/ 10**	_____ **/ 4**	Q4 Explain _____ **/ 12**
SET: _____  DUE: _____	**KT1.2: Rational Explanations: Hippocrates, Galen & The Four Humours** *"Why did the Theory of the Four Humours dominate rational medicine for centuries?"* ☐ **Read Aloud / Audio Tracked** **10-Q Online Quiz Score:** _____ **/ 10** **Parent / Carer Signature:** _____	**KT 1.2 RECALL** _____ **/ 10**	_____ **/ 4**	Q4 Explain _____ **/ 12**
SET: _____  DUE: _____	**KT1.3: Approaches to Prevention & Treatment: Rituals, Bleeding & Purging** *"How did medieval people attempt to treat and prevent disease, and why did rational and religious methods coexist?"* ☐ **Read Aloud / Audio Tracked** **10-Q Online Quiz Score:** _____ **/ 10** **Parent / Carer Signature:** _____	**KT 1.3 RECALL** _____ **/ 10**	_____ **/ 4**	Q4 Explain _____ **/ 12**
SET: _____  DUE: _____	**KT1.4: Medical Care Providers & Monastic Hospitals: 'Care Not Cure'** *"Who provided medical care in medieval England, and why did hospitals focus on care rather than cure?"* ☐ **Read Aloud / Audio Tracked** **10-Q Online Quiz Score:** _____ **/ 10** **Parent / Carer Signature:** _____	**KT 1.4 RECALL** _____ **/ 10**	_____ **/ 4**	Q4 Explain _____ **/ 12**
SET: _____  DUE: _____	**KT1.5: Case Study: Dealing with the Black Death (1348–1349)** *"Why did medieval society fail to halt the devastating mortality of the Black Death?"* ☐ **Read Aloud / Audio Tracked** **10-Q Online Quiz Score:** _____ **/ 10** **Parent / Carer Signature:** _____	**KT 1.5 RECALL** _____ **/ 10**	_____ **/ 4**	Q5/6 Essay _____ **/ 20**

Retain this student assessment record for parent consultations and GCSE revision monitoring.